

Google LLC (/ˈɡuː.ɡəl/[ⓘ], *GOO-gəl*) is an American [multinational technology corporation](#) focused on [information technology](#), [online advertising](#), [search engine](#) technology, [email](#), [cloud computing](#), software, [quantum computing](#), [e-commerce](#), consumer electronics, and [artificial intelligence](#) (AI).^[9] It has been referred to as "the most powerful company in the world" by the [BBC](#),^[10] and is one of the world's [most valuable brands](#).^{[11][12][13]} Google's parent company [Alphabet Inc.](#) has been described as a [Big Tech](#) company.

Google was founded in 1998 by American computer scientists [Larry Page](#) and [Sergey Brin](#). Together, they own about 14% of its publicly listed shares and control 56% of its stockholder voting power through [super-voting stock](#). The company went [public](#) via an [initial public offering](#) (IPO) in 2004. In 2015, Google was reorganized as a wholly owned subsidiary of Alphabet Inc. Google is Alphabet's largest subsidiary and is a [holding company](#) for Alphabet's internet properties and interests. [Sundar Pichai](#) was appointed CEO of Google in 2015, replacing Larry Page, who became the CEO of Alphabet. In 2019, Pichai also became the CEO of Alphabet.^[14]

After the success of its original service, [Google Search](#) (often known simply as "Google"), the company has rapidly grown to offer [a multitude of products](#) and [services](#). These products address a wide range of use cases, including email ([Gmail](#)), navigation and mapping ([Waze](#), [Maps](#), and [Earth](#)), cloud computing ([Cloud](#)), [web navigation](#) ([Chrome](#)), video sharing ([YouTube](#)), productivity ([Workspace](#)), [operating systems](#) ([Android](#) and [ChromeOS](#)), [cloud storage](#) ([Drive](#)), language translation ([Translate](#)), photo storage ([Photos](#)), [videotelephony](#) ([Meet](#)), [smart home](#) ([Nest](#)), [smartphones](#) ([Pixel](#)), [wearable technology](#) ([Pixel Watch](#) and [Fitbit](#)), music streaming ([YouTube Music](#)), video on demand ([YouTube TV](#)), AI ([Google Assistant](#) and [Gemini](#)), [machine learning](#) APIs ([TensorFlow](#)), AI chips ([TPU](#)), and more. Many of these products and services are dominant in their respective industries, as is Google Search. [Discontinued Google products](#) include [gaming](#) ([Stadia](#)),^[15] [Glass](#), [Google+](#), [Reader](#), [Play Music](#), [Nexus](#), [Hangouts](#), and [Inbox by Gmail](#).^{[16][17]} Google's other ventures outside of internet services and consumer electronics include quantum computing ([Willow](#), [Google Quantum AI](#)), [self-driving cars](#) ([Waymo](#)), and [transformer models](#) ([Google DeepMind](#)).^[18]

Google Search and YouTube are the two [most-visited websites](#) worldwide, followed by [Facebook](#), [Instagram](#), and [ChatGPT](#). Google is the largest provider of search engines, mapping and navigation applications, [email services](#), [office suites](#), [online video platforms](#), photo and [cloud storage](#), [mobile operating systems](#), [web browsers](#), machine learning frameworks, and AI [virtual assistants](#) in the world as measured by market share.^[19] Google

was ranked the second most valuable brand by *Forbes* as of January 2022,^[20] and fourth by Interbrand as of February 2022.^[21] [The company has received criticism](#) involving issues such as [privacy concerns](#), [tax avoidance](#), [censorship](#), [search neutrality](#), [antitrust](#), and abuse of its [monopoly](#) position.^[22]